

29 This is the meaning. Indeed, those persons, whose bodies have become hot due to heat, undertake actions merely on the basis of observation of a cold lake insofar as they desire to bathe in its water. They do not deliberate in the meantime [in the following manner]: “The water in the visible lake is capable of alleviating heat, because it is cold water. Everything that is cold water is capable of alleviating heat, just like the water of the Ganges. And we are hot. So, for the sake of alleviating that heat, we shall bathe here.” Moreover, these different things—the heat, the water located in the lake, its capacity to alleviate heat, and so on—are objects of which one is aware separately. Furthermore, unless these are synthesized with each other, there is no to-be-done-ness. And, when this to-be-done-ness is absent, there is no conscious practical undertaking of an autonomous person. Also, with respect to the synthesis, there is no means of knowing that usually operates. Therefore, it is to be accepted that linguistic impression, whose nature is unknown (asaṃviditarūpa), is the cause of the pratibhā that takes the form, “This is to be done by this means in this way.”⁴⁴ The last line of the passage claims that this pratibhā is caused by linguistic impressions. Why must we think so? Why can the underlying impression not be just a memory impression left by inferential awareness-events that took place in a previous birth? Vācaspati addresses this objection. The following is not to be said: “Whatever [awareness] appears wherever either due to a previous birth or insofar as it is produced by that birth, let there be a seed of an impression for that [awareness] in that case. What is the point of language?” Since an impression that is produced by a non-recollective inferential awareness (ānumānikānubhava) does not cause an awareness that has the form of to-be-done-ness because that inferential awareness has a fact (bhūtārtha) as its intentional object, and, in this case [where the agent performs an action], there is no awareness of a mere synthesis which lacks the form of to-be-done-ness.⁴⁵ The impression that gives rise to the practical insight about to-be-done-ness must originate from language, since the other means of knowing, such as inference, etc., only gives us access to facts, ⁴⁴ NK on VVS §11.3, 487.10-17: ayam arthaḥ | santāpataptatanavo hi śītahradadarśanamātrād apsu mimaṅkṣavaḥ pravartante | nāntarā vicārayanti | dṛśyamānāhradagatā āpas tāpam apanetuṃ samarthāḥ śīśiratoyatvāt | yad yat toyam śīśiram tat sarvaṃ tāpāpanodanasamartham yathā gaṅgātoyam | vyaṃ ca taptāḥ | tad iha tatpraśamanāya nimajjāmaha iti | nānā caite padārthā vicchinna pratipattayaḥ santāpo hradādhārā āpas tāsāṃ santāpopaśamanasāmarthyam ity ādayaḥ | na caiteṣāṃ parasparopaśleṣam antareṇa kartavyatā | na cāsyāṃ asatyāṃ svatantracetanapravṛttiḥ | na copāśleṣe samudācāravṛtti kiñcit pramāṇam asti | tasmād asaṃviditarūpā śabdabhāvanaivedam ittham anena kartavyam iti pratibhāhetur āstheyāḥ | For a variant, see VVMG 178.6-12. ⁴⁵ NK on VVS §11.3, 487.17-18 and 488.1: na caivaṃ vācyam | prāgbhavīyaṃ tajjanmajaṃ vā yatra yat pratibhāti tatra tadbhāvanā bījam astu | kiṃ śabdeneti ānumānikānubhava janmano bhāvanāyā bhūtārthagocaratvena kartavyatākārapratītyakāraṇāt kartavyatākārahitasya cātropaśleṣamātrasyāpratīteḥ | For a variant, see VVMG 178.12-15.